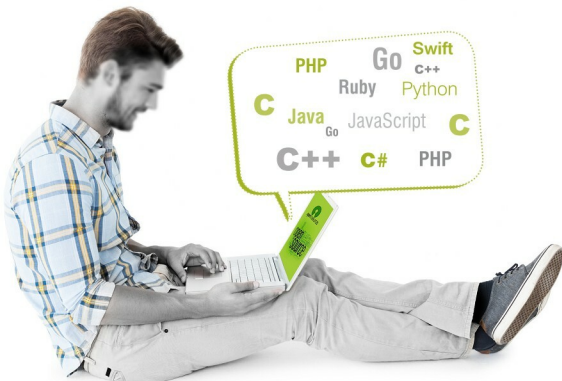


The Top 10 List of Popular Programming Languages

Here is a list of the ten most popular programming languages of 2016. Most of you might raise an eyebrow at the selection, wondering, 'How is it possible to rank a programming language?' Read on to know how the author has arrived at his choices.



Ranking programming languages is a highly subjective and controversial topic. So in case you're wondering how I came up with this list, let me explain. First of all, I have considered the four most popular rankings of programming languages, namely the TIOBE Index, the RedMonk Programming Language Rankings, the PYPL (Popularity of Programming Language) Index, and the IEEE Spectrum Ranking of Programming Languages.

The ranking metrics used by these four indexes vary considerably, so preferring one ranking over another is meaningless. TIOBE Index uses the search volume in popular search engines such as Google, Bing, Yahoo! and Baidu, and websites like Wikipedia, Amazon and YouTube as the criterion to gauge a language's popularity. A programming language like C, which is widely studied in schools, colleges and universities, will have a clear advantage, while a language like Go, which is not popular with academia will be at a disadvantage with the

ranking metric followed by TIOBE Index.

The RedMonk Programming Language Rankings uses a programming language's GitHub and Stack Overflow presence as a measure of popularity. Stack Overflow is a discussion forum for programming languages and GitHub is a code repository. In this ranking scheme, older languages or those with a small set of built-in library functions are at a disadvantage compared to newer languages and those with a large set of built-in library functions, especially while quantifying the presence in Stack Overflow. For example, an older language like C with a small set of library functions will be trailing behind newer languages like Python and JavaScript with a large set of library functions.

The PYPL (Popularity of Programming Language) Index uses the service of Google Trends to rank programming languages. The ranking is based on